water fish are carps, catla, rohu, murrels and hilsa. Fish contains complete proteins and can be an alternative for meat in the diet, but unfortunately fish consumption per capita is far lower than that of meat.

4.3.1 Classification of Fish

Edible fish are categorized as either fin fish of shell fish. The term fin fish refers to the fishes that have bony skeleton. Shell fish is used to designate both mollusks and crustaceans. Shellfish are highly perishable.

Crustaceans have legs with partly joined outer shells. They include crabs, lobsters, prawns and shrimps. Molluscs have harder outer shells and no legs. They have hinged shells like oysters, scallops and mussels.

4.3.2 Composition and nutritive value

Commonly consumed fish are carp, rohu, sardine, mackerel pomfrets, seer fish, prawns, ribbons fish, sole, Bombay duck, catfish and crab.

The composition of fish varies. Fish are not good source of energy because they are not good sources of carbohydrate and fat.

Carbohydrate: The shell fish has less fat and more carbohydrate than fin fish. Like meat, fish contain some glycogen in muscle tissues. In the live fish, glycogen is the source of stored energy. Oysters are notable for their high content of glycogen.

Protein : Fish is an excellent source of protein due to its quality and quantity. They contain around 20 percent protein. The biological value of fish protein is 80. Fish is rich in lysine and methionine hence it has supplementary value with cereals and pulses.

Fat : Fish contains less amount of fat compared to meat and poultry. Fresh

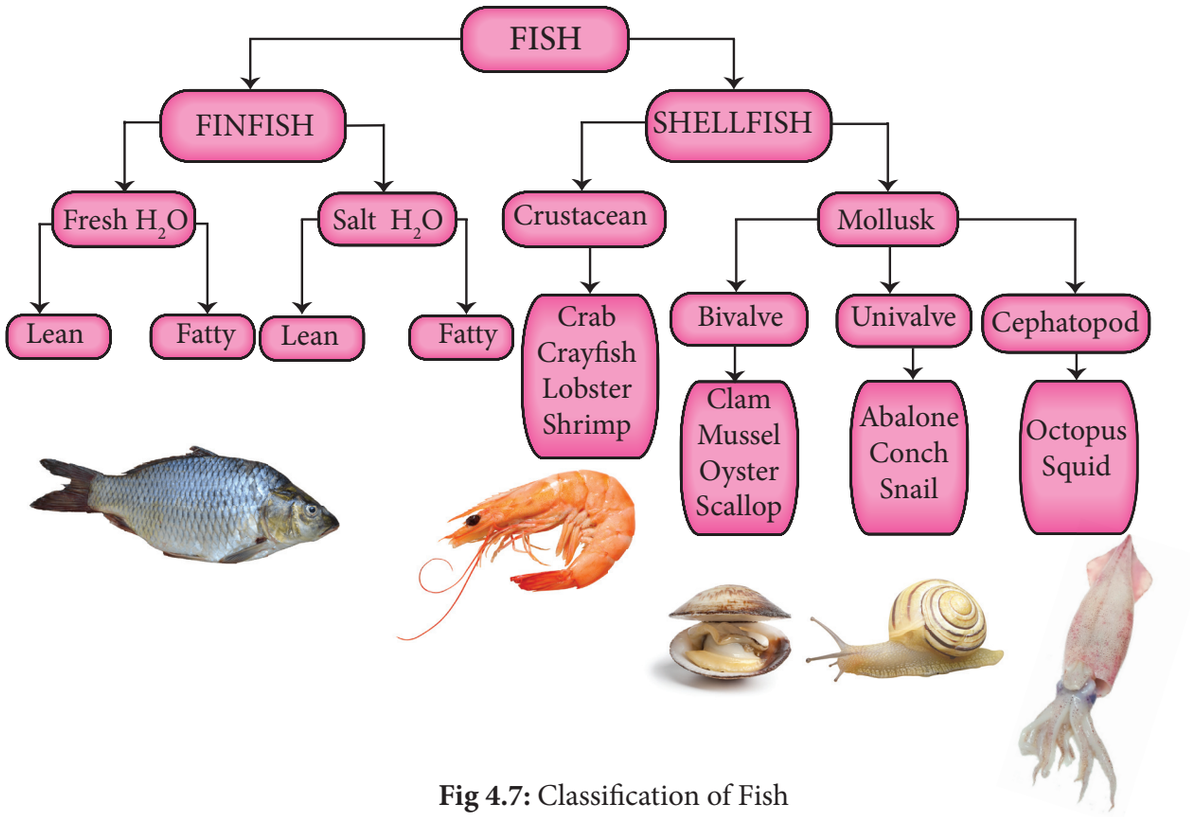


Fig 4.7: Classification of Fish

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